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Accessing Clinical Data

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COMP90089



Research with human subjects always carries risks

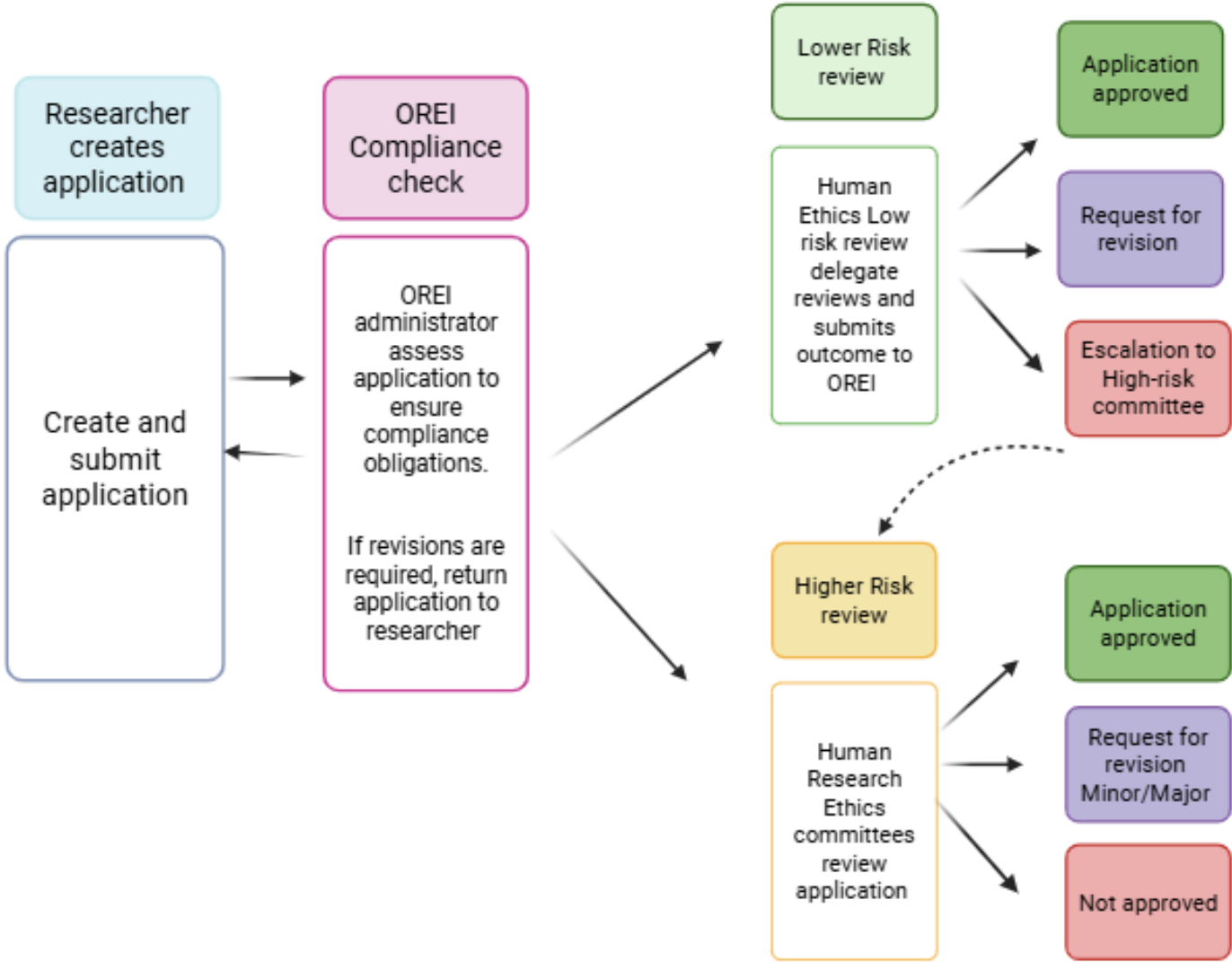


Research with data about humans IS human subjects research



Research needs to be approved by an ethics committee (HREC)
before accessing data

Overview



Risk classification (NHMRC)

Figure 1: Risk profiles of research

Lower risk		Higher risk (Individual, group, community, societal or global)	
Minimal	Low	Greater than low	High
No risk of harm or discomfort; potential for minor burden or inconvenience*	No risk of harm; risk of discomfort (+/- foreseeable burden)	Risk of harm (+/- foreseeable burden)	Risk of significant harm (+/- foreseeable burden)

* Burden and inconvenience are discussed below.

Risk classification (NHMRC)



- physical harm: including injury, illness, pain or death
- psychological harm: including feelings of worthlessness, distress, guilt, anger, fear or anxiety related, for example, to disclosure of sensitive information, an experience of re-traumatisation, or learning about a genetic possibility of developing an untreatable disease
- devaluation of personal worth: including being humiliated, manipulated or in other ways treated disrespectfully or unjustly
- cultural harm: including misunderstanding, misrepresenting or misappropriating cultural beliefs, customs or practices
- social harm: including damage to social networks or relationships with others; discrimination in access to benefits, services, employment or insurance; social stigmatisation; and unauthorised disclosure of personal information
- economic harm: including the imposition of direct or indirect costs on participants
- legal harm: including discovery and prosecution of criminal conduct.

“Discomfort is considered less serious than harm. It can involve physical or psychological impacts; for example, minor side effects of medication, discomfort related to non-invasive examinations or tests (such as measuring blood pressure), and mild anxiety associated with an interview. However, **where a person’s reactions might exceed discomfort and become distress, this should be viewed as potential for harm.”**

(bolded words are my own)

Risk not only for the participating individuals

Genetic Research among the Havasupai: A Cautionary Tale

Robyn L. Sterling, JD, MPH

The New York Times

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Indian Tribe Wins Fight to Limit Research of Its DNA



Jim Wilson/The New York Times

Edmond Tilousi, 56, who can climb the eight miles to the rim of the Grand Canyon in three hours. [More Photos »](#)

By AMY HARMON

Published: April 21, 2010

Risks of research with human data



- Risk to individuals
- Risk to the communities or social groups they belong to

Privacy vs Confidentiality



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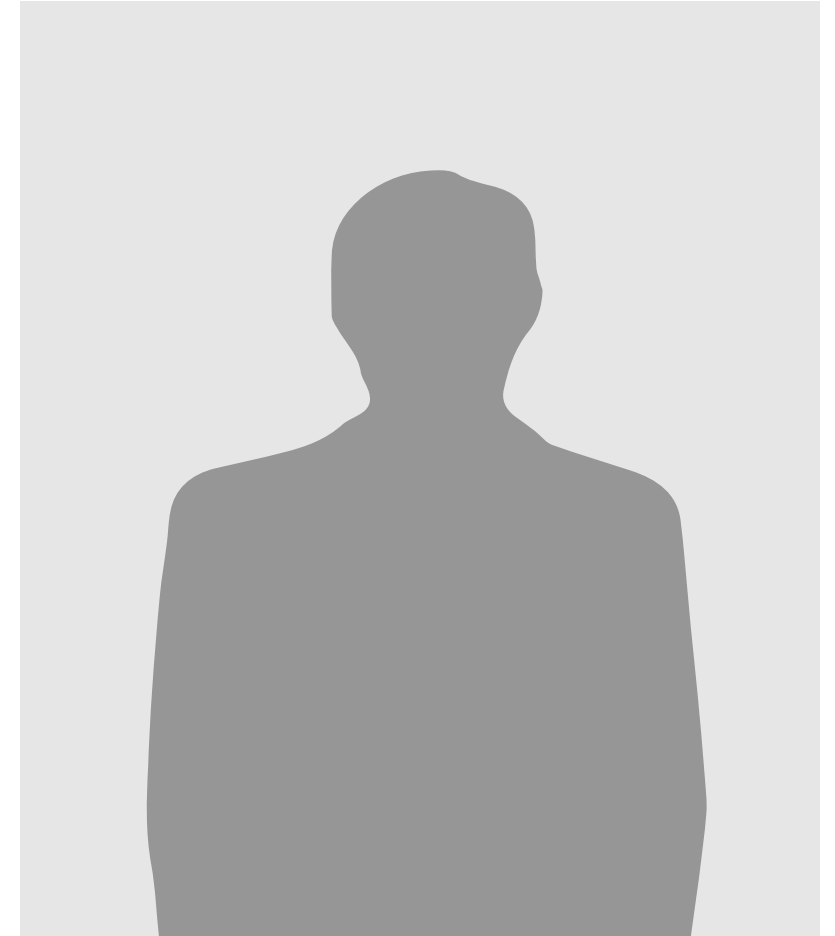
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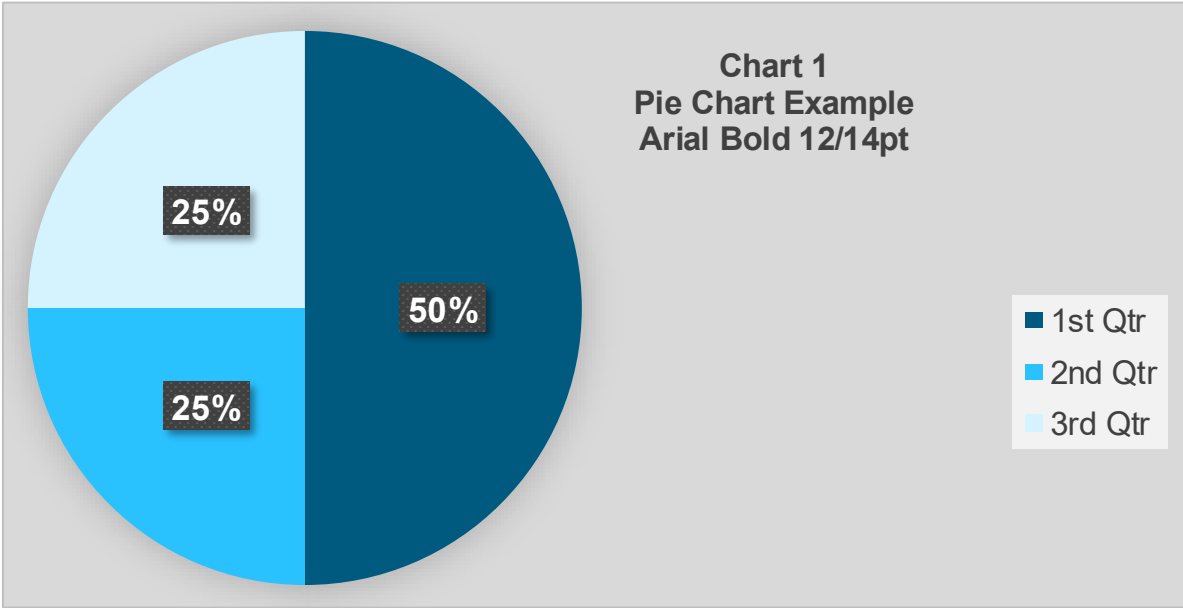
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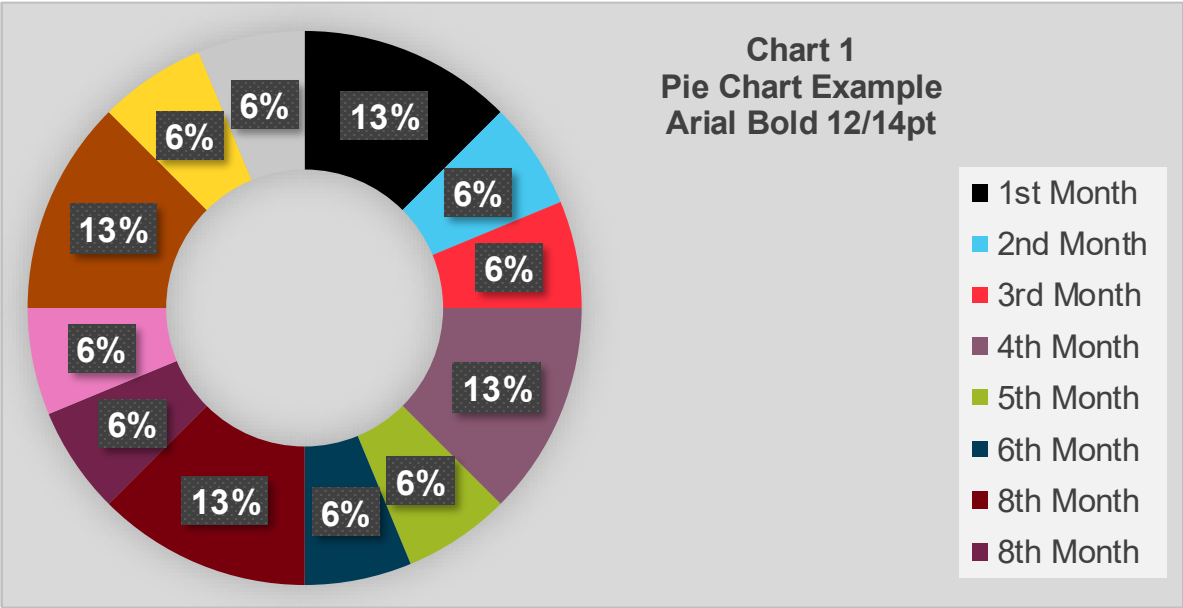
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